

Centre plans ₹50 billion for rare earth independence

The Indian government is eyeing an expansion of its rare earth magnet scheme to over ₹50 billion, targeting an annual output of 6000MT, up from 1500MT, to reduce reliance on imports for EVs, defence, and electronics. The seven-year plan will back at least five producers, meet rising demand, and tap India's 6.9 million MT reserves, with industry majors like JSW, Mahindra, and Sona Comstar in talks.

Government greenlights ₹46 billion boost for four new projects under ISM

The central cabinet has approved four new projects worth ₹46 billion: SiCSem, Continental Device India (CDIL), 3D Glass Solutions, and ASIP Technologies, which are expected to create 2034 skilled jobs under the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM). These units in Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, and Punjab will boost production in defence, AI, EVs, and electronics. With this, 10 projects under ISM now total ₹1.6 trillion investments across six states.

UK drops duties on Indian electronics in FTA

India and the UK have signed a landmark CETA, granting 99% duty-free access for Indian exports, including smartphones, fibre cables, and inverters. The deal, expected to double trade to US\$112 billion by 2030, also removes duties on UK components and eases social security rules for Indian professionals, boosting electronics manufacturing and global competitiveness.

ISRO-NASA \$1.5 billion NISAR Satellite takes off from Sriharikota

ISRO and NASA have launched NISAR, a \$1.5 billion dual-frequency radar satellite and their first joint Earth-observation hardware mission. Equipped with L- and S-band systems, it will monitor natural disasters, climate change, and infrastructure stability. The three-year mission, extendable by two years, underscores Indo-US space cooperation and supports India's \$44 billion space economy goals by 2033.

NITI Aayog flags urgent measures to triple EV penetration by 2030

India's EV sales increased from 50,000 in 2016 to 2.08 million in 2024; however, the penetration remains at 7.66%, compared to a global average of 16.48%. NITI Aayog's new report calls for tripling the EV share in five years to meet 2030 goals, citing China and Vietnam as models, and urging the adoption of mandates, city-wide rollouts, freight corridor hubs, financing reforms, and battery R&D.

Andhra Pradesh's new EMS policy attracts ₹18 billion investment from Syrma SGS

Andhra Pradesh has approved the Electronics Component Manufacturing Policy 2024-29, offering capital subsidies, land discounts, and tax benefits to boost production of



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